Scheduled Tribes (STs)

The Special Central Assistance (SCA) to the Tribal Sub- Plan (TSP), is a 100 per cent grant extended to states as additional funding to their TSPs for family-oriented income-generating schemes, creation of incidental infrastructure, extending financial assistance to SHGs, community-based activities, and development of forest villages. Human Development funds are provided to states with the objective of promoting the welfare of STs and improving administration of scheduled areas in conjunction with other schemes/programmes. The Scheme for Post-Matric Scholarship with 100 per cent financial assistance to ST students whose family income is less than or equal to Rs. 2 lakh per annum for pursuing post-matric-level education including professional, graduate, and postgraduate courses in recognized institutions, the Scheme for Top Class Education for STs providing financial assistance for quality education to 625 ST students per annum to pursue studies at degree and post-degree levels in any of the 183 identified institutes, the National Overseas Scholarship Scheme with financial assistance to 15 eligible ST students for pursuing higher studies abroad in specified fields and the Scheme for Strengthening of Education among ST Girls in low literacy districts are some other schemes for the development of STs. Some measures for economic impowerment of STs include extension of financial support through the National Scheduled Tribes Finance and Development Corporation (NSTFDC) in the form of loans and micro-credit at concessional rates of interest for income-generating activities and in market development of tribal products and their retail marketing through its sales outlets by the Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Limited (TRIFED).

Other Backward Classes (OBCs)

The government provides central assistance to state governments/ UT administrations for educational development of OBCs. Under the revised Scheme of Post-Matric Scholarship for OBCs, it is proposed to provide scholarship to 17.25 lakh OBC students. in order to provide hostel facilities to OBC students studying in middle and secondary schools, colleges, and universities to enable them to pursue higher studies.